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CURRENT AFFAIRS



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India assumes Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time; appoints Vivek Agrawal

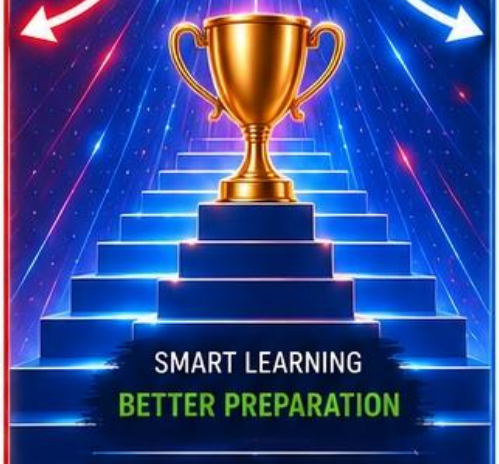
In June 2025, India was elected as Vice-President of the Financial Task Force (FATF) for the first time. This reflects India's commitment to global standards in combating money laundering and terrorist financing.

Exam Hint:

- **What:** Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time
- **Who:** Vivek Agrawal
- **Body:** Financial Action Task Force (FATF)
- **Term:** July 2025 to June 2027
- **Significance:** Helps build trust and recognition.

PDF

- Complete Coverage
- Exam Hint Focused
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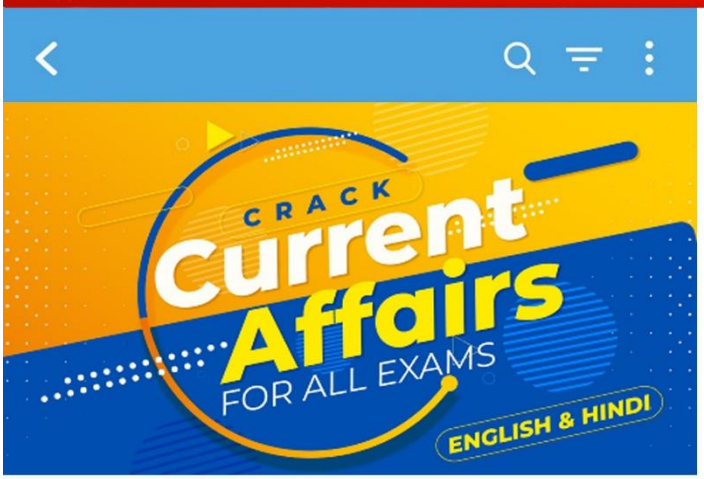
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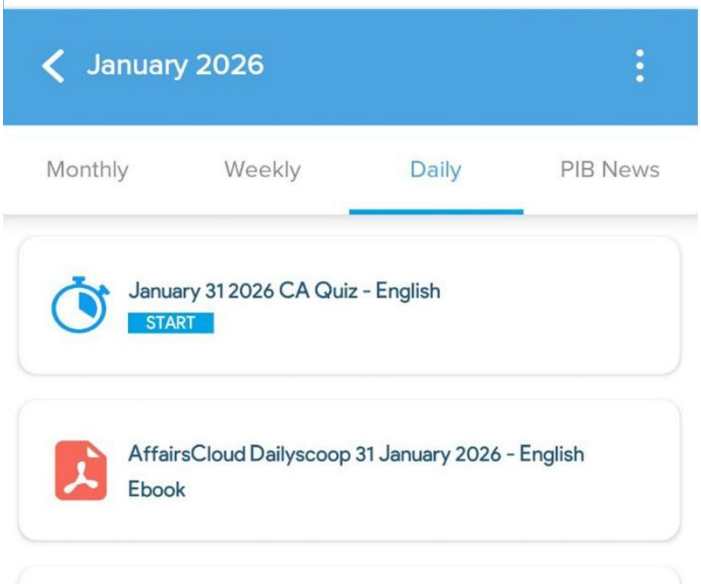
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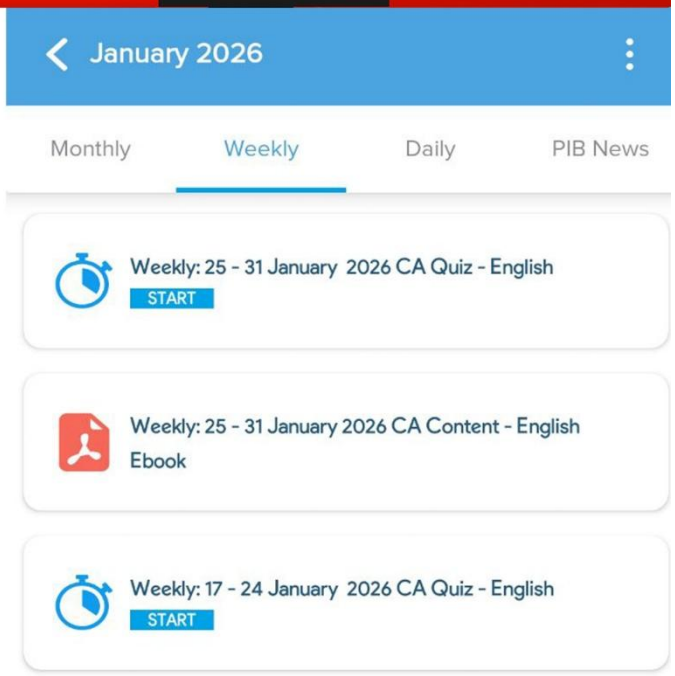
Bank & Insurance

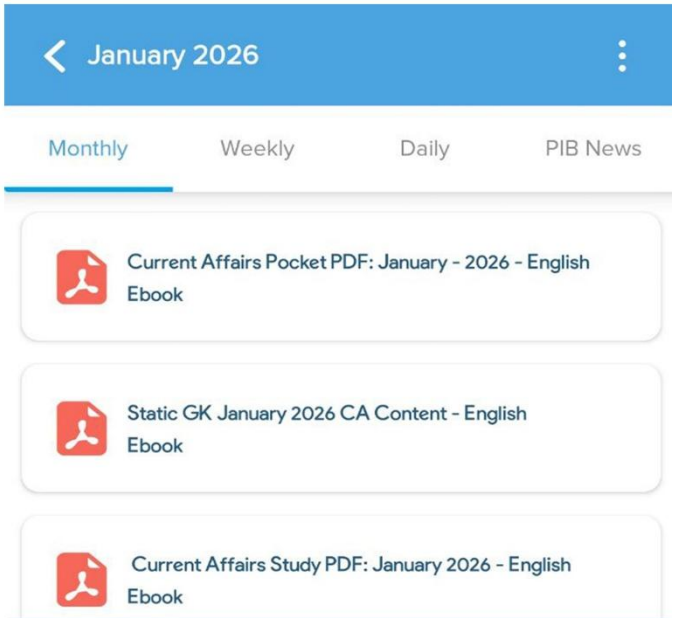
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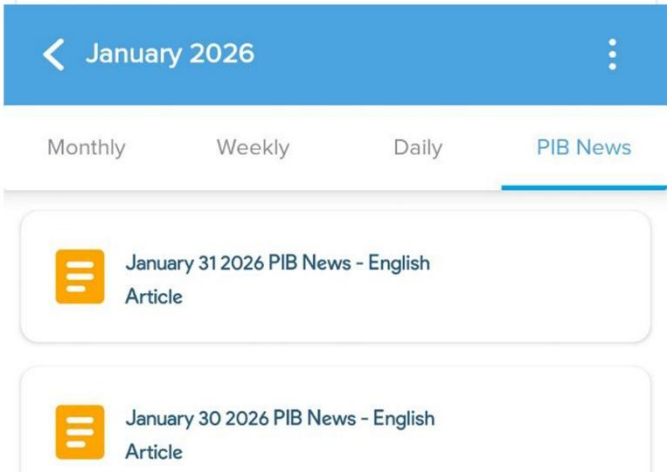
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HandWritten Notes

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NATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)

MoRD —Notified→ Grievance Redressal Rules,2026 for VB-G RAM G Scheme under the VB-G RAM G Act, 2025.

🎯 Objective: Transparent and time-bound grievance redressal.

VB-G RAM G Grievance Redressal Rules:

- 🏛️ System: Three-tier mechanism – Gram Panchayat, Block and District.
- 👤 Officers: GROs; DPC oversees district-level redressal.
- ⏳ Timeline: Investigation – 7 working days; resolution – 15 days.
- 🔁 Escalation: Unresolved complaints automatically escalated digitally after 15 days.
- 📝 Complaints: Oral or written; acknowledgement with registration number; no rejection based on language or format.
- ❌ Omissions: Mandatory FIR registration and grievance action-taken reports before Panchayat meetings removed.

VB-G RAM G Scheme:

- 📅 Implementation: Replaced MGNREGA from 1 July 2026.

MoRD – Ministry of Rural Development

MGNREGA – Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act

GRO – Grievance Redressal Officer

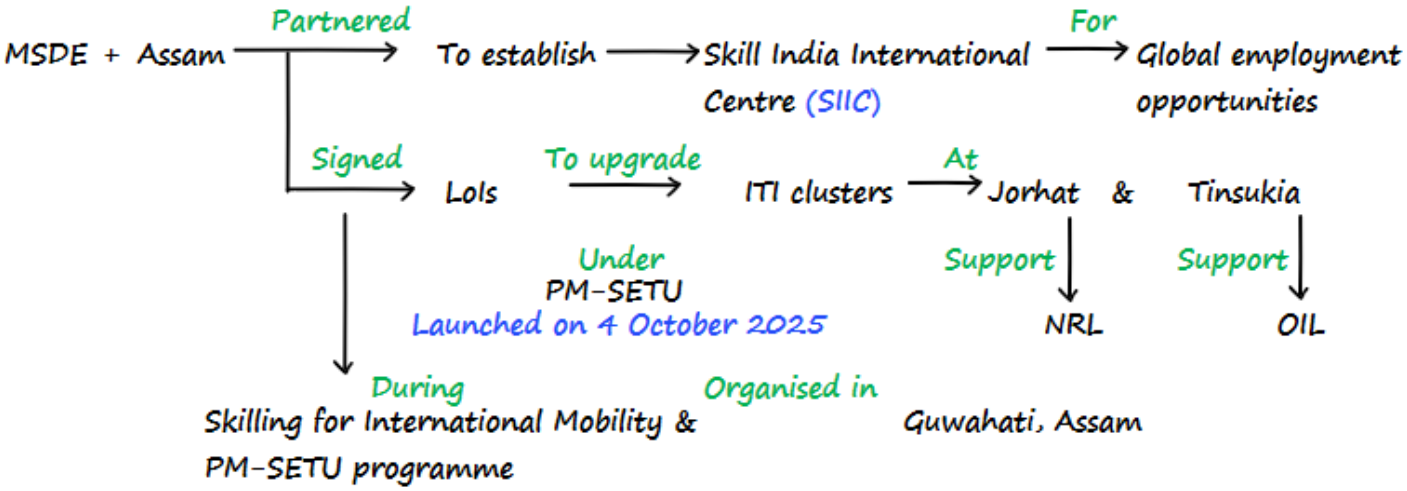
DPC – District Programme Coordinator

FIR – First Information Report

DBT – Direct Benefit Transfer

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2)



🎯 Objective: Strengthen North-East skilling infrastructure, industry participation and international workforce mobility.

MSDE – Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

LoI – Letter of Intent

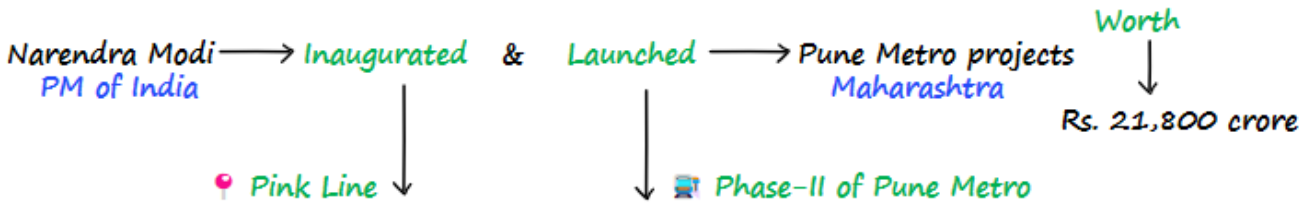
ITI – Industrial Training Institute

NRL – Numaligarh Refinery Limited

OIL – Oil India Limited

PM-SETU – Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs

3)

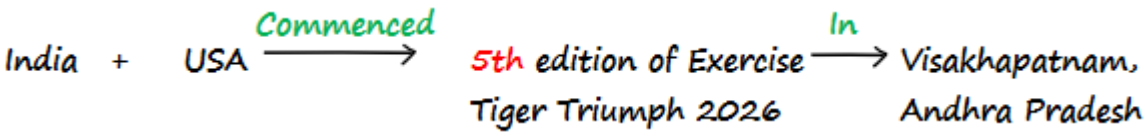


- 23-km elevated Line 3, connecting Maan-Hinjewadi IT Park to District Court, built at Rs. 8,300+ crore
- Entire Pink Line to be operated by women train operators; 30% power from solar energy

- Foundation stone laid for projects worth Rs. 13,500 crore
- Lines 2A-2B cover 12.75 km (Vanaz-Chandani Chowk and Ramwadi-Vitthalwadi)
- Lines 4-4A connect Kharadi-Khadakwasla (25.52 km) and Nal Stop-Manik Baug (6.12 km).

IT – Information Technology

4)



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Tabletop Exercise

↓

🎯 Objective: Strengthen joint planning, coordination and interoperability for Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR) operations.

🇮🇳 Indian Participation: Includes the Indian Navy, Army, Air Force, Special Forces and NDRF (first-time participation).

USA – United States of America

NDRF – National Disaster Response Force

5)

NITI Aayog + TEXMiN —Signed→ Joint Statement of Intent (SoI) —Strengthen→ India's critical and strategic minerals ecosystem —Through→ Indigenous technology & innovation

SoI —During→ Prof. Gobardhan Das's visit to IIT (ISM) Dhanbad, Jharkhand

Member of NITI Aayog

Dhanbad → Coal Capital of India

↓ Inaugurated

National Symposium on Critical Minerals and Rare Earths (CMRE 2026)

Ashok Kumar Lahiri
NITI Aayog Vice Chairman —Launched→ Interactive India Science & Technology Scoreboard —In→ New Delhi

🎯 Objective: Enables evidence-based policymaking, State benchmarking and identification of research and innovation gaps.

NITI – National Institution for Transforming India

TEXMiN – Technology Innovation in Exploration & Mining Foundation

IIT (ISM) – Indian Institute of Technology (Indian School of Mines)

6)

Bihar —Becomes→ 1st Indian State —To Introduce→ Comprehensive Silt Management Policy, 2026

🎯 Objective: Desilting, river restoration and flood control.

🌊 Cause: Nepal-origin rivers bring heavy silt, reducing river capacity.

🌾 Agriculture: Farmland desilting; reuse of silt in construction.

🏗️ Implementation: RCD, NHAI and State Coordination Committee.

🚧 Nadi Sanjivani: MoRTH–Bihar MoU for desilting and silt reuse in highways.

RCD – Road Construction Department

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NHAI – National Highways Authority of India

MoRTH – Ministry of Road Transport and Highways

MoU – Memorandum of Understanding

7)

Ashutosh Dixit (Air Chief Marshal) —Introduced→ "VAYU" Vision —To Strengthen→ Indian Air Force (IAF)

🎯 Objective: Readiness, self-reliance and modernisation.

- V – Vigilance: Combat readiness.
- A – Aatmanirbharta: Indigenous defence capabilities.
- Y – Yukti: AI, innovation and counter-drone capabilities.
- U – Unity: Jointness with Army, Navy and agencies (JAI).

🛡️ Scroll Control Programme: Child digital safety programme covering 42 Air Force Schools.

AI – Artificial Intelligence

JAI – Jointness, Aatmanirbharta and Innovation

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)

🏛️ Quacquarelli Symonds (QS) —Released→ 📄 QS Asia University Rankings 2027 —Topped by→ ⏳ University of Hong Kong (100 Score)

Top 5 Universities in Asia 2027:

Rank	University Name	Country
1	The University of Hong Kong	Hong Kong, SAR of China
2	Peking University	Beijing, China
3	Tsinghua University	Beijing, China
4	City University of Hong Kong (CityUHK)	Kowloon, Hong Kong SAR China
5	The Chinese University of Hong Kong (CUHK)	Hong Kong, SAR China

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Top 5 Indian Universities in Asia 2027:

Rank	Institution/University Name
66	Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IIT-D), New Delhi, Delhi
79	Indian Institute of Science (IISc) Bengaluru, (Bengaluru, Karnataka)
83	IIT Bombay (IIT-B), (Mumbai, Maharashtra)
85	IIT Madras (IIT-M), (Chennai, Tamil Nadu, TN)
90	IIT Kharagpur (IIT-KP), (Kharagpur, West Bengal, WB)

Country-wise representation
- 1st – Mainland China: 448 Universities
- 2nd – India: 325 Universities
- 3rd – Japan: 153 Universities
- New Indian Entrants: 34

SAR -Special Administrative Region

BANKING & FINANCE

1)

IRDAI —To Implemented→ 4 Layer Motor Insurance structure & Tightens ESOP Norms

From 15 December 2026 for private cars & 2 wheelers

🚗 Four-Layer Motor Insurance:

🎯 Objective: Flexible coverage and transparent premiums.

📋 Disclosure: Separate coverage and premium details; integration with Bima Sugam.

Four Sections:

- I: Mandatory third-party liability.
- II: Optional occupant, pillion and employee liability.
- III: Owner-driver and optional passenger personal accident cover.
- IV: Optional own-vehicle damage cover.

📊 ESOP & Share Transfer Norms:

💰 Fee: Reduced from Rs. 50 lakh to Rs. 10 lakh (80%).

🗓️ Effective: 2 November 2026.

📈 Approval: Prior approval at 5%, 10%, 25%, 50% and 75% shareholding thresholds.

📄 IPO: Issue size, purpose and shareholding disclosure.

👥 ESOP: Prior approval for excess holdings by directors/KMPs.

📑 Reporting: Actuarial assessment and capital allotment details within 15 days.

IRDAI – Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India

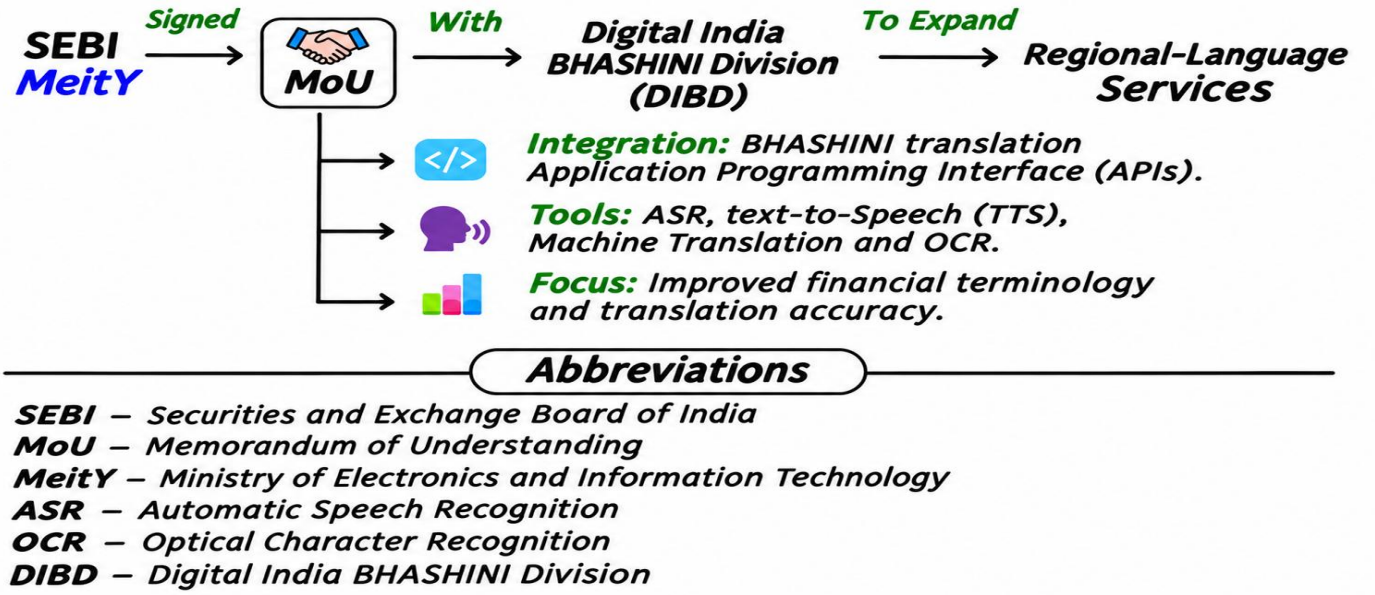
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ESOP – Employee Stock Option Plan

IPO – Initial Public Offering

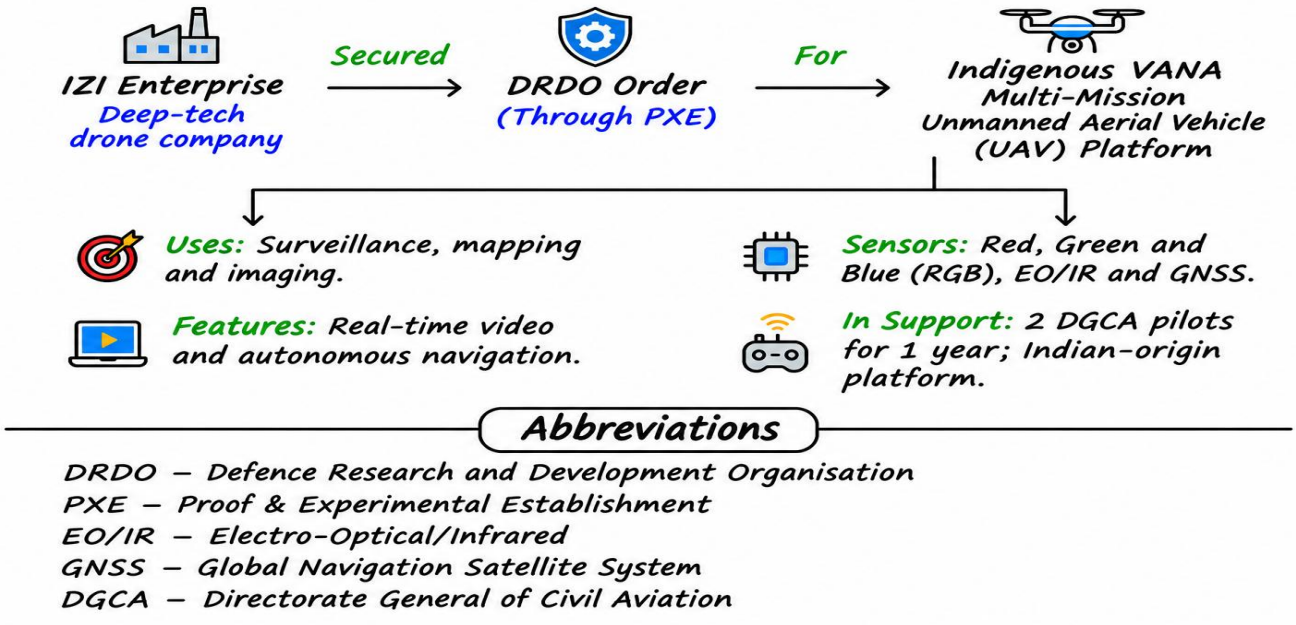
KMP – Key Managerial Personnel

2)



ECONOMY & BUSINESS

1)



APPOINTMENT & RESIGNATIONS

1)

Equitas Small Finance Bank → Succeeded → P. N. Vasudevan

Appointed → Balaji Nuthalapadi → As → Interim Chief Executive Officer (CEO)

🏛 Approval: Subject to RBI approval.

📌 Previous Roles: Head of South Asia O&T (2021); MD, Centralized Controls Testing Execution (2024).

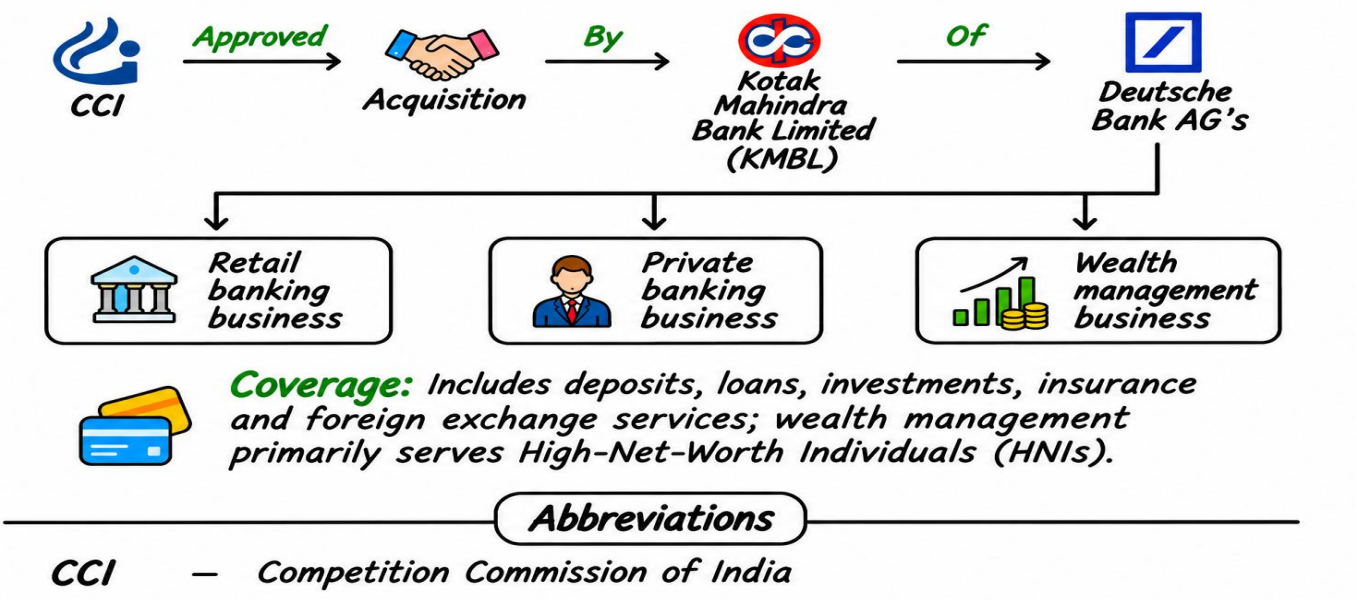
RBI – Reserve Bank of India

MD – Managing Director

O&T – Operations and Technology

ACQUISITION & MERGER

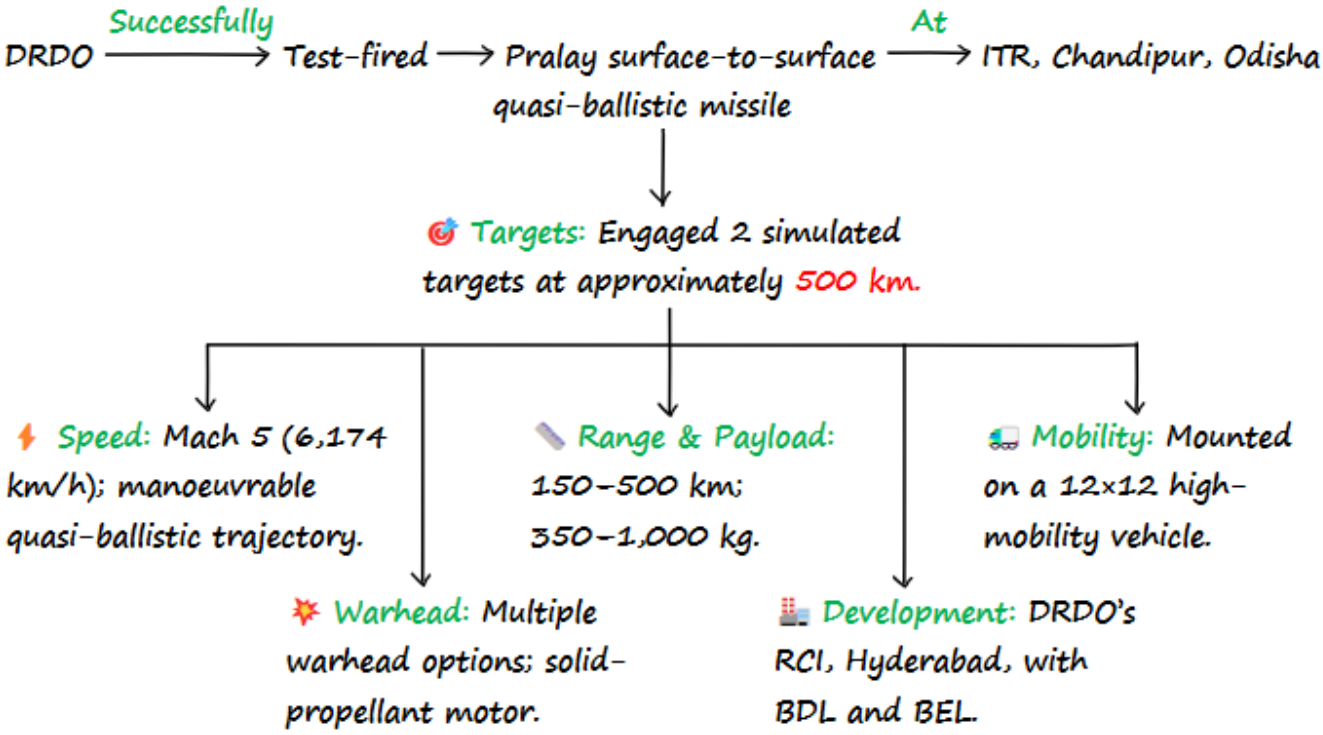
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SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

1)



DRDO – Defence Research and Development Organisation

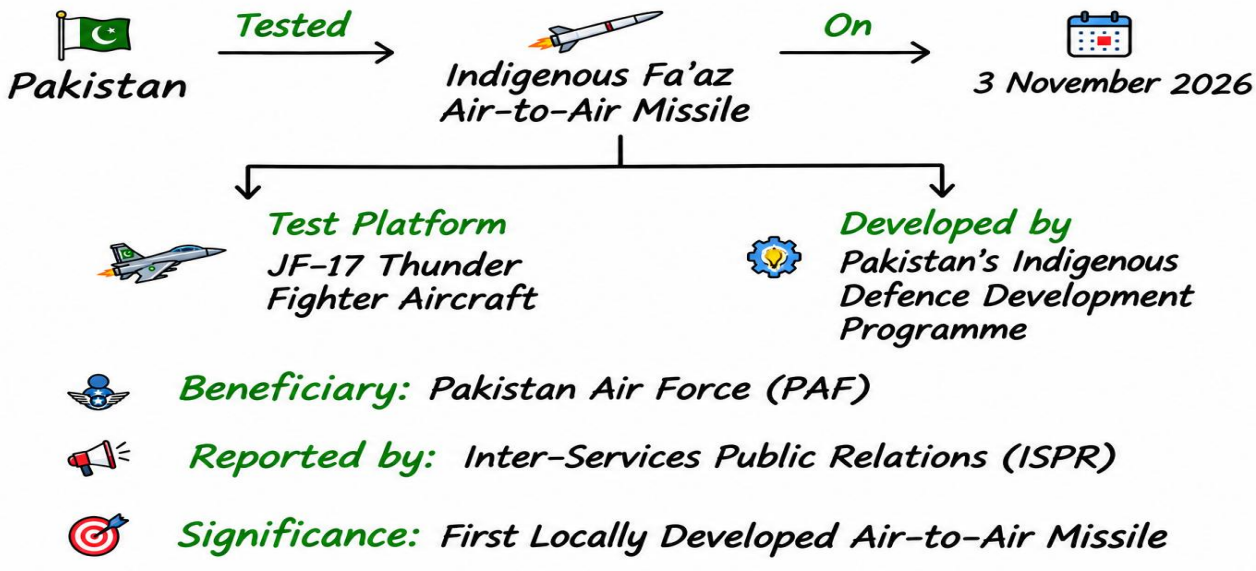
ITR – Integrated Test Range

RCI – Research Centre Imarat

BDL – Bharat Dynamics Limited

BEL – Bharat Electronics Limited

2)



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SPORTS

1)

Indian Boxers —Topped in→ 46th International Tammer Boxing Tournament —With→ 14 Medals (4 Gold, 2 Silver, 8 bronze) —In→ Tampere, Finland

- Organiser: Tampere Boxing Association.

IN Team: 14-member squad; 10 men's and 7 women's categories.
Gold Medallists: Aarti Dhariyal (54 kg), Ankushita Boro (65 kg), Arundhati Chaudhary (70 kg) and Pawan Bartwal (55 kg).
Indian Army: Arundhati Chaudhary, Pawan Bartwal and Tanu won medals.

IMPORTANT DAYS

1)

5 November 2026 → World Tsunami Awareness Day —Awareness→ Tsunami preparedness and early warnings

- 2026 Theme: "Be Tsunami Ready: Resilience Starts With You".
- First Observance: 5 November 2016.
- Observance: 11th observance in 2026.
- 2026 Event: Interactive session at UNCC, Bangkok, on 27 October, organised by UNDRR-ROAP, UN-ESCAP, UNDP and UNESCO-IOC.

UNDRR – UN Office for Disaster Risk Reduction
UNCC – United Nations Conference Centre
UN-ESCAP – United Nations Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific
UNDP – United Nations Development Programme
UNESCO – United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
IOC – Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission
ROAP – Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific.

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Detailed Content

Current Affairs 5 November 2026: Headlines



- MoRD Notifies Grievance Redressal Rules, for VB-G RAM G Scheme
- MSDE Partners with Assam to Establish SIIC; Signs LoIs for Two ITI Clusters Under PM-SETU
- PM Narendra Modi Inaugurates and Lays Foundation Stone of Pune Metro Projects worth around Rs 21,800 Crore
- India and USA Commence 5th Edition of 'Exercise Tiger Triumph' in Visakhapatnam, AP
- NITI Aayog and TEXMiN Sign Joint SoI to Strengthen India's Critical Minerals Ecosystem
- Bihar Becomes First Indian State to Introduce Comprehensive Silt Management Policy, 2026
- Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit Introduces 'VAYU' Vision to Strengthen the Indian Air Force
- QS World University Rankings Asia 2027: The University of Hong Kong Tops; IIT Delhi Slips to 66th
- IRDAI To Implement Four Layer Motor Insurance Structure, Tightens ESOP Norms
- SEBI Signs MoU with Digital India BHASHINI Division to Expand Regional-Language Services
- IZI Enterprise Secures DRDO Order for Indigenous VANA Multi-Mission UAV Platform
- Equitas Small Finance Bank Appoints Balaji Nuthalapadi as Interim CEO
- CCI Approves KMBL's Acquisition of Deutsche Bank's Retail and Wealth Management Businesses
- DRDO Successfully Tests Pralay Quasi-Ballistic Missile off Odisha Coast
- Pakistan Successfully Tests Indigenous Fa'az Air-to-Air Missile
- Tammer Boxing Tournament 2026: India Tops with 14 Medals Including 4 Gold
- World Tsunami Awareness Day 2026 – November 5

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NATIONAL AFFAIRS

MoRD Notifies Grievance Redressal Rules,2026 for VB-G RAM G Scheme

In November 2026, the Ministry of Rural Development **(MoRD)** notified the Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) **(VB–G RAM G) Grievance Redressal Rules, 2026**, under the VB–G RAM G Act, 2025, to establish a structured, transparent and time-bound grievance redressal mechanism for the rural employment scheme.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Notification of Grievance Redressal Rules, 2026
- ✓ **For?** VB-G RAM G Scheme
- ✓ **Notified by:** MoRD
- ✓ **Key Features:**
  - **Multi-tier redressal system** (GP, block and district level);
  - **Stringent timelines** (7 days for completion of investigation and 15 days for complete disposal of grievances);
  - **Key Provisions Omitted:** Registration of FIR in cases with prima facie evidence of embezzlement; and submission of action-taken report before the GPs.

About Grievance Redressal Rules 2026:

Multi-tier System: The new grievance redressal rules has directed the state to establish grievance redressal mechanisms at Gram Panchayat (GP), Block and District levels.

Managed by: MoRD has designated Grievance Redressal Officers **(GROs)** at the appropriate levels, who will be mainly responsible for receiving, registering, enquiring into and resolving grievances.



- At district-level, the District Programme Coordinator **(DPC)** will oversee grievance redressal to ensure that grievances are addressed through the designated mechanism and the Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) for grievance redressal.

Timelines: The newly notified rules prescribed strict timelines for resolving the grievances i.e. completion of investigation within **7 working days** from the date of receipt and final resolution within **15 days.**

Escalation of Unresolved Complaints: The complaints that remain unresolved after 15 days will be automatically escalated through digital platforms for redressal of grievance to the next higher-level.

- Such complaints will continue to be monitored digitally until they are disposed of.

Mode for Registration of Complaints: The new rules allows any person to submit a complaint concerning the implementation of the scheme, either orally or in writing.

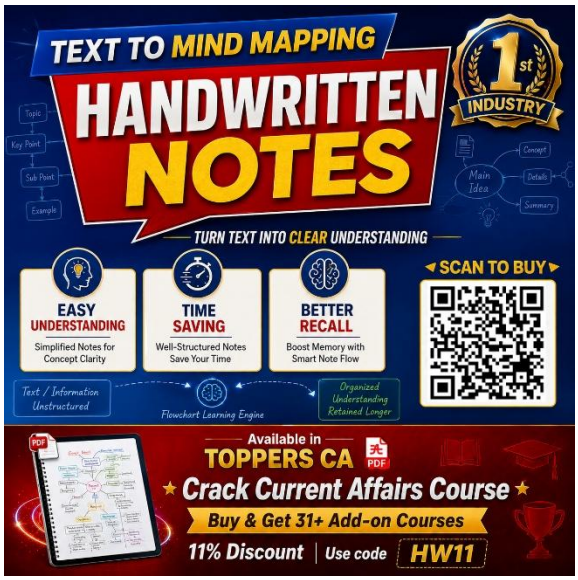
- **Digital Registration:** Complaints filed physically at all 3-levels must be registered on the digital platform on the day they are received or, where this is not feasible, by the next working day.
- **Acknowledgement of Complaints:** Every registered complaint receives an acknowledgement containing a registration number, the date of receipt and the designation of the receiving authority.
- **No Refusal:** The designated officers cannot refuse to register/oversee grievances based on format, language, manner of submissions, or procedural errors.

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Appeals: The aggrieved party/person can appeal against decisions under the grievance redressal mechanism. Such appeals will be handled in accordance with clauses (i) (j) and (k) of paragraph 28 **schedule I to the VB-G RAM Act, 2025.**

Omission of Key Provisions of MGNREGA: The MoRD has omitted two previous provisions of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA):

- The mandatory requirement to register an First Information Report (FIR) when preliminary inquiries or social audits revealed prima facie evidence of financial irregularities;
- Requirement to submit action-taken reports on grievances before panchayat and district panchayat meetings for review and monitoring.



About Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB–G RAM G):

Repealed MGNREGA: The VB-G RAM Act, 2025 repealed the MGNREGA, 2005, starting from **July 1, 2026.**

Extended Employment Guarantee: The new act provides a statutory guarantee of **125 days** of work in **every financial year** (up from the provision of 100 days in MGNREGA, 2005) to every household whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work.

Wage Payments: Under the scheme, wages to labourers are disbursed through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) into their bank or post office accounts.

- Also, payments are processed within **three days,** ensuring that all procedures are completed and the funds reach their accounts within a maximum time period of 15 days.
- However, if the funds are not received within 15 days, workers are entitled to receive delayed payment compensation.
- Further, workers are entitled to get an unemployment allowance, if employment is not provided upon demand.

About Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD):

Union Minister- Shivraj Singh Chauhan (Constituency- Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh, MP)
Union Minister of State **(MoS)-** Chandra Shekhar Pemmasani (Constituency- Guntur, Andhra Pradesh, AP); and Kamlesh Paswan (Constituency- Bansgaon, Uttar Pradesh, UP)

MSDE Partners with Assam to Establish SIIC; Signs LoIs for Two ITI Clusters Under PM-SETU

On 2 November 2026, the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship **(MSDE)** organised the **'Skilling for International Mobility** & Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs **(PM-SETU) programme** in **Guwahati, Assam,** focusing on the Tourism and Hospitality sector.

- During the programme, **MSDE** announced a partnership with the **Government of Assam** to establish a Skill India International Centre **(SIIC)** and signed Letters of Intent **(LoIs)** for upgrading two Industrial Training Institute **(ITI) clusters** under the PM-SETU scheme.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Skilling for International Mobility & PM-SETU
- ✓ **Organised By:** MSDE
- ✓ **Where?** Guwahati, Assam
- ✓ **Focus Sector:** Tourism and Hospitality
- ✓ **Partnerships Announced:**

- **MoU for SIIC:** MSDE + Government of Assam
- **LoI for Jorhat ITI Cluster:** Supported by NRL
- **LoI for Tinsukia ITI Cluster:** Supported by OIL

About the Programme:

Objectives: Strengthening the North-Eastern Region's skilling infrastructure, expanding international employment opportunities and transforming ITIs through industry participation.

Participation: Bringing together representatives of the Central and Assam Governments, industry stakeholders and the skilling ecosystem, with a special focus on the Tourism and Hospitality sector to address the growing demand for skilled professionals in domestic and international markets.

Key Partnerships and ITI Cluster Development:

SIIC: The MoU between MSDE and Government of Assam aims to establish a SIIC in Assam to strengthen international workforce mobility by providing industry-aligned training, internationally recognised certifications and pathways to overseas employment, while preparing young people to meet global industry requirements.

PM-SETU: LoIs were signed for two ITI clusters at Jorhat and Tinsukia in Assam under the PM-SETU scheme, with support from Numaligarh Refinery Limited (NRL) for Jorhat and Oil India Limited (OIL) for Tinsukia.

Transformation: The partnerships aim to strengthen industry participation and promote industry-led transformation of the vocational education and training ecosystem in the North-Eastern Region by converting ITIs into modern, demand-driven and industry-responsive institutions aligned with emerging workforce requirements.



About PM-SETU Scheme:

Overview: The PM-SETU scheme is a flagship, Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS) for vocational education, launched by the Government of India (GoI) on 4 October 2025, which completed its first year of implementation in October 2026.

Implementation: The scheme is implemented by the Directorate General of Training **(DGT)** under the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE).

Objectives: The scheme aims to restructure and modernise India's vocational training network in alignment with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047.

Outlay: The scheme has a total financial outlay of Rs. 60,000 crore over five years, with contributions from the Central Government (Rs. 30,000 crore; 50%), State Governments (Rs. 20,000 crore; 33.3%) and industry partners (Rs. 10,000 crore; 16.7%).

- The scheme includes co-financing support from the Asian Development Bank (ADB) and the World Bank (WB) towards the Central Government's share.

About Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE):

Union Minister of State **(MoS)** (Independent Charge, IC) – Jayant Chaudhary (Rajya Sabha member- Uttar Pradesh, UP)

PM Narendra Modi Inaugurates and Lays Foundation Stone of Pune Metro Projects worth around Rs 21,800 Crore

In November 2026, Prime Minister **(PM) Narendra Modi** inaugurated and laid the foundation stone for Pune Metro projects (Maharashtra) worth **around Rs 21,800 crore** via video conferencing.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Virtual Inauguration and Laying of foundation stone for Pune Metro Projects
- ✓ **Inaugurated by:** PM Narendra Modi
- ✓ **Total Cost:** Around Rs 21,800 crore
- ✓ **Project -1:** Pune Metro Line (Pink Line)
  - **Development Cost:** Over Rs 8,300 crore
  - **Total Length:** approximately 23 kms
  - **Connects:** Maan (Hinjewadi IT hub) and District Court Metro Station (Shivajinagar)
  - **Operated by:** Entirely by Women
- ✓ **Project-2:** Phase-II of Pune Metro
  - **Estimated Cost:** Rs 13,500 crore
  - **Components:** Lines 2A, Line 2B, Line 4, Line 4A

Key Details of Pune Metro Projects:

Connectivity: The newly inaugurated 23-kilometers (kms) fully elevated Pune Metro Line 3 (Pink Line), developed at a cost of over **Rs. 8,300 crore**, connects Maan-Hinjewadi Information Technology (IT) Park with the District Court Metro station in Shivajinagar, improving access to Pune's major employment hub.

- **Operation and Power:** The entire corridor will be operated by women train operators and around 30% of the corridor's power requirements will be met through solar energy.
- **Other Key Benefits:** In addition, the corridor is expected to reduce reliance on private vehicles, ease traffic congestion and vehicular emissions, among others.

Phase-II of Pune Metro: He laid the foundation stone of Phase-II of Pune Metro which is expected to be built at an estimated cost of **Rs 13,500 crore.** The key components of the proposed corridor are:

- **Lines 2A and Line 2B:** The cumulative length of these two lines is around 12.75 kms. Line 2A will connect Vanaz to Chandani Chowk, while Line 2B will link Ramwadi to Vitthalwadi, extending the existing east-west metro network.
- **Line 4 and Line 4A:** It spans around 25.52 kms, connecting Kharadi to Khadakwasla, while Line 4A spans 6.12 kms, connecting Nal Stop to Manik Baug.

Key Milestone Achieved by CRPF:

Zero Casualties: PM Modi lauded the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) for achieving zero operational casualties over 12 consecutive months for the 1st time in 47 years.

Last Fatality: Gyanendra Pratap Singh, Director General (DG) of CRPF informed that the last fatality was recorded on October 30, 2025.

Key Factors: CRPF DG further highlighted key contributing factors which helped in achieving this milestone are: enhanced hardware, better training, strategic planning and deployment and quick injured evacuation to secondary and tertiary medical care facilities.

About CRPF: It is India's largest Central Armed Police Force (CAPF) and functions under the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA). It assists State and Union Territory (UT) governments in maintaining law and order, combating internal insurgencies, and safeguarding national integrity.

About Maharashtra:

Chief Minister **(CM) –** Devendra Fadnavis
Governor- Jishnu Dev Varma
Capital – Mumbai
National Parks **(NPs) –**Sanjay Gandhi NP, Chandoli NP

India and USA Commence 5th Edition of 'Exercise Tiger Triumph' in Visakhapatnam, AP

On 2 November 2026, **India** and the United States of America **(USA)** commenced the **'Exercise Tiger Triumph 2026'**, the 5th edition of bilateral Tri-Service Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR)

exercise, at the Maritime Warfare Centre (MWC) in Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh (AP).

- The opening ceremony was presided over by Rear Admiral **(RAdm)** Vishal Bishnoi, Flag Officer Commanding Eastern Fleet, Indian Navy **(IN)** and Rear Admiral **(RAdm)** Joaquin J. Martinez de Pinillos, Vice Commander, USA Pacific Fleet.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Exercise Tiger Triumph-2026
- ✓ **Participating Countries:** India and USA
- ✓ **Where?** Visakhapatnam, AP
- ✓ **Type:** Bilateral Tri-Service HADR Exercise
- ✓ **2026 Format:** Tabletop Exercise
- ✓ **First-time Participation:** NDRF
- ✓ **First Edition:** November 2019.

Background:

First Edition: The first edition of Exercise Tiger Triumph was held in November **2019** near Visakhapatnam and Kakinada, AP, marking the beginning of India–USA Tri-Service cooperation in HADR operations.
4th Edition: The previous edition of the exercise was conducted from 1 to 11 April 2025 at Visakhapatnam and Kakinada, AP.
Other Bilateral Defence Exercises: India and the USA conduct several joint military exercises, including Yudh Abhyas, Vajra Prahar, Malabar and Cope India, along with multilateral exercises such as Rim of the Pacific (RIMPAC) and Sea Dragon, to strengthen defence cooperation and interoperability.

About Exercise Tiger Triumph 2026:

Format: The exercise is being conducted as a Tabletop Exercise **(TTX)** to strengthen joint planning, coordination and interoperability between the Armed Forces of both countries during large-scale disaster relief operations
Focus: The exercise aims to facilitate Combined Joint All-Domain Operations, strengthening cooperation across multiple operational domains during humanitarian emergencies.

Participation:

- **Indian Contingent:** The Indian contingent comprises specialists from the Indian Navy (IN), ground personnel from the Indian Army (IA), representatives from the Indian Air Force (IAF) and Special Forces from all three Services. The National Disaster Response Force **(NDRF) i**s participating for the **first time**, contributing specialised disaster-response capabilities.
- **USA Contingent:** The USA contingent comprises personnel from the US Army, Navy, Air Force and Marine Corps, along with specialists in Space, Cyber, Medical and Explosive Ordnance Disposal (EOD).

Key Activities: The exercise includes all-domain TTX, command and control coordination, cyber and space synchronisation, subject-matter expert exchanges, community outreach and cultural events.

About Indian Navy (IN):

Chief of the Naval Staff **(CNS)** – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan (27th CNS)
Headquarters – New Delhi, Delhi
Established – 1950

NITI Aayog and TEXMiN Sign Joint SoI to Strengthen India's Critical Minerals Ecosystem

In November 2026, National Institution for Transforming India **(NITI) Aayog** and **TEXMiN** (Technology Innovation in Exploration & Mining Foundation), signed a Joint Statement of Intent **(SoI)** to strengthen India's **critical and strategic minerals sector** through indigenous technology development, research and innovation.

- The collaboration aligns with the objectives of the National Critical Mineral Mission **(NCMM)** and the vision of Aatmanirbhar Bharat and Viksit Bharat 2047, focusing on technological self-reliance and resilient domestic supply chains.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Joint SoI on critical minerals signed
- ✓ **Entities:** NITI Aayog and TEXMiN
- ✓ **Where?** IIT (ISM) Dhanbad, Jharkhand
- ✓ **Purpose:** Strengthen collaboration in critical and strategic minerals sector
- ✓ **Other Launch:** NITI Aayog launched India S&T Scoreboard
- ✓ **Objective:** To support evidence-based S&T policymaking and State benchmarking.

About NITI Aayog-TEXMiN SoI:

Agreement: The SoI was signed during the visit of Prof. Gobardhan Das, Member, NITI Aayog, to Indian Institute of Technology (Indian School of Mines) [IIT (ISM)] Dhanbad, Jharkhand, where he inaugurated the National Symposium on Critical Minerals and Rare Earths (CMRE 2026), held as part of the 45th Annual National Conference of the Indian Council of Chemists.

Focus: The partnership covers four areas: collaborative research and technology development, technical and strategic studies, policy and institutional support, and capacity building and knowledge exchange to strengthen India's critical minerals ecosystem.

Value Chain: An integrated value chain covering exploration, processing, refining, advanced materials and recycling, with critical mineral recovery from coal fly ash, red mud, mine tailings and electronic waste, will promote indigenous technologies and sustainable resource utilisation.

About TEXMiN: Established in 2020 as a Technology Innovation Hub (TIH) under the Department of Science and Technology (DST), Ministry of Science and Technology (MoS&T), it was upgraded to a Technology Translation Research Park (TTRP) at IIT (ISM), Dhanbad, Jharkhand.

NITI Aayog Launches India S&T Scoreboard:

In November 2026, **Ashok Kumar Lahiri,** Vice Chairman of NITI Aayog, launched the interactive **India Science & Technology (S&T) Scoreboard** at the Civil Services Officers' Institute (CSOI), KG Marg, New Delhi, Delhi.

Objectives: The platform provides an integrated overview of the science and technology landscape across Indian States and Union Territories (UTs), enabling evidence-based policymaking, performance benchmarking and identification of research and innovation strengths and gaps.

Coverage: The Scoreboard consolidates data on higher education institutions, Research and Development (R&D) institutions, deep-tech startups, incubators, research publications and patents across **three sectors:** Academia, Government R&D Laboratories and Industry.

Significance: Guided by cooperative and competitive federalism, the platform enables State comparisons, identifies strengths and gaps, promotes best-practice sharing.

About National Institution for Transforming India (NITI) Aayog:

Chief Executive Officer **(CEO)** – Anurag Jain
Headquarters – New Delhi, Delhi
Established – 2015

Bihar Becomes First Indian State to Introduce Comprehensive Silt Management Policy, 2026

On 3 November 2026, Bihar Chief Minister **(CM) Samrat Choudhary** highlighted the Bihar Water Sources Restoration and Silt Management Policy, 2026, notified on 17 September 2026, making Bihar the **first state in India** to formulate a **comprehensive state-level silt management policy.**

- The policy aims to restore rivers and other water bodies through scientific desilting, improve their water-carrying capacity, strengthen flood management and utilise excavated silt in construction projects.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Bihar Water Sources Restoration and Silt Management Policy, 2026
- ✓ **First State:** Bihar
- ✓ **Announced By:** CM Samrat Choudhary
- ✓ **Objective:** Scientific desilting, river restoration and flood management
- ✓ **Nodal Department:** Road Construction Department (RCD), Bihar
- ✓ **Related Initiative:** Nadi Sanjivani
- ✓ **MoU Partners:** MoRTH and Government of Bihar.

About Comprehensive Silt Management Policy, 2026:

Background: Rivers originating in Nepal carry substantial quantities of water and sediment into Bihar, making the state vulnerable to recurring floods. Continuous silt accumulation reduces river-carrying capacity, obstructs water flow and affects agricultural land.

Agricultural Protection: The policy allows removal of sand and silt deposited on farmland after floods and promotes the use of excavated sediment in construction instead of fertile topsoil.

Implementation: Bihar's Road Construction Department (**RCD**) will coordinate the initiative with NHAI, supported by a State-level Coordination Committee.

Nadi Sanjivani Initiative: the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways **(MoRTH)** and the Government of Bihar signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to promote scientific desilting and reuse of extracted silt in National Highway projects.

Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit Introduces 'VAYU' Vision to Strengthen the Indian Air Force

In November 2026, **Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit**, the 29th Chief of the Air Staff (CAS) of the Indian Air Force (IAF), unveiled **'VAYU'** as the guiding vision for the IAF, to strengthen operational preparedness, accelerate indigenous capabilities and ensure a technologically advanced, self-reliant and seamlessly integrated force.

Exam Hint:

- ✓ **What?** Launch of 'VAYU' Vision
- ✓ **Launched By:** Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit
- ✓ **VAYU:**
  - V – Vigilance, Victory and Readiness
  - A – Aatmanirbharta (Self-reliance)
  - Y – Yukti (Ingenuity)
  - U – Unity of Effort
- ✓ **Related Vision:** Jointness, Aatmanirbharta and Innovation
- ✓ **ScrollControl Programme:** Child Digital Safety Programme.

About 'VAYU' Vision:

V – Vigilance, Victory and Readiness: Maintain the highest state of operational preparedness across all IAF formations and restore combat strength to sanctioned levels.

A – Aatmanirbharta (Self-reliance): Accelerate indigenous capabilities in platforms, **sensors, weapons and technologies** to ensure operational self-reliance and sustained combat capability.

Y – Yukti (Ingenuity): Drive innovation in military doctrine, technology and operational procedures, including **AI-enabled command** and control, **counter-drone capabilities**, resilience and emerging operational domains.

U – Unity of Effort: Strengthen jointness with the Indian Army (IA), Indian Navy (IN) and national agencies,

in line with Jointness, Aatmanirbharta and Innovation (JAI).

ScrollControl Programme: On 2 November 2026, **IAF** Educational and Cultural Society partnered with the Information Sharing and Analysis Center **(ISAC)** Foundation to implement **ScrollControl**, a Child Digital Safety Programme, across 42 Air Force Schools in India.

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

QS World University Rankings Asia 2027: The University of Hong Kong Tops; IIT Delhi Slips to 66th

In November 2026, global higher education analyst **Quacquarelli Symonds (QS)** released the QS World University Rankings: Asia 2027, revealing that **71% of previously ranked Indian universities declined in their positions**, despite India's strong performance in research productivity and doctoral education.

- **Mainland China** led in representation with 448 universities, followed by India (325) and Japan (153), while the **University of Hong Kong** topped the rankings, followed by Peking University and Tsinghua University.
- Indian Institute of Technology Delhi **(IIT-D)** was India's highest-ranked institution at **66th,** with 34 new Indian entrants.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** QS World University Rankings: Asia 2027
- ✓ **Released by:** Quacquarelli Symonds (QS)
- ✓ **Coverage:** 1,722 universities across 26 higher education systems
- ✓ **Top 3 Most Represented Countries:** Mainland China (ranks 1st, 448 universities); Indian (ranks 2nd, 325 universities); and Japan (ranks 3rd, 153 universities)
- ✓ **India's Highest-Ranked Institution:** IIT Delhi (66th)
- ✓ **Asia's Top University:** University of Hong Kong

QS World University Rankings (Asia) 2027:

Coverage: The latest edition of the rankings featured **1,722** universities across 26 higher education systems, with 195 new entrants.

Methodology: Published annually since 2009, universities are ranked based on their performance across 11 indicators such as:

- academic reputation (30%); employer reputation (20%); faculty/student ratio (10%); international research network (10%); citations per paper (10%) and paper per faculty (5%); staff with Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) (5%); proportion of international faculty (2.5%) and proportion of international students (2.5%);
- Proportion of inbound exchange students (2.5%) and proportion of outbound exchange students (2.5%).

Top Ranked Asian University: The **University of Hong Kong,** Hong Kong Special Administrative Region (SAR) China with an overall score of perfect **100** retained the top position in 2027 rankings for the **2nd** consecutive year.

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Top 5 Universities in Asia 2027:

Rank	University Name	Country	Overall Score
1	The University of Hong Kong	Hong Kong, Special Administrative Region (SAR) of China	100
2	Peking University	Beijing, China	99.8
3	Tsinghua University	Beijing, China	99.7
4	City University of Hong Kong (CityUHK)	Kowloon, Hong Kong SAR China	99.1
5	The Chinese University of Hong Kong (CUHK)	Hong Kong, SAR China	98.9

Top 5 Indian Universities in Asia 2027:

Rank	Institution/University Name	Overall Score
66	Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IIT-D) New Delhi, Delhi	77.9
79	Indian Institute of Science (IISc) Bengaluru (Bengaluru, Karnataka)	76.3
83	IIT Bombay (IIT-B) (Mumbai, Maharashtra)	75.5
85	IIT Madras (IIT-M) (Chennai, Tamil Nadu, TN)	75
90	IIT Kharagpur (IIT-KP) (Kharagpur, West Bengal, WB)	74.3

India-Specific:

Top-ranked Indian Institutions: All top 6 ranked Indian institutions slipped in the latest rankings. Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi (IIT-D) again emerged as India's top-ranked institution/university (declined to 66th spot from 59th in last year's edition).

- It is followed by Indian Institute of Science (IISc) Bengaluru, Bengaluru, Karnataka (from 64th to 79th); IIT Bombay (IIT-B), Mumbai, Maharashtra (from 71st to 83rd); IIT Madras (IIT-M), Chennai Tamil Nadu (TN) (from 70th to 85th); IIT Kharagpur, Kharagpur, West Bengal (WB) (90th spot).

Steepest Decline: Among Indian-ranked universities, the steepest declines were at Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam (Kerala) (-202 places, 495th to 697th); Osmania University (-180 places, from 470th to 650th); and Madurai Kamaraj University (-173 places, from 458th to 631st).

- Despite strong representation, 71% of Indian universities witnessed decline in their rankings, while 18% rose and 11% held steady. However, Indian universities performed well in research, as 27 universities featured in Asia's top 50 for Paper per faculty.

Top Gainers: Indian universities which have improved their rankings compared to last year: Chandigarh University (CU), Punjab (from 109th to 104th); Lovely Professional University (LPU), Jalandhar (Punjab) (from 187th to 154th); Symbiosis International University, Pune (Maharashtra) (from 200th to 175th).

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- Some of the Government institutions improved their rankings such as: IIT-Hyderabad (IIT-H), Hyderabad, Telangana (from 270th to 251st); IIT Banaras Hindu University (BHU) Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh (UP) (from 237th to 219th), among others.

Indicator-wise Performance: Indian universities performance declined across key indicators: Academic reputation (which holds 30% weightage) decreased for 76% of Indian universities; Employer Reputation (20% weightage) declined for 83%; international student indicator dropped for 85%; inbound and outbound exchange fell for 91% and 89%, respectively.

About QS (Quacquarelli Symonds):

Chief Executive Officer **(CEO)-** Jessica Turner

Headquarters- London, the United Kingdom (UK)

Established in- 1990

BANKING & FINANCE

IRDAI To Implement Four Layer Motor Insurance Structure, Tightens ESOP Norms

In November 2026, the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (**IRDAI**) directed general insurers to implement a **four-layer** motor insurance policy structure for private cars and two-wheelers from **15 December 2026.**

- The IRDAI has tightened rules governing shares issued to employees of insurance companies under Employee Stock Option Plans (**ESOPs**) and also reduced the share transfer approvals fees.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** IRDAI directed four-layer motor insurance structure
- ✓ **Effective from:** 15 December 2026
- ✓ **Coverage:** Private cars and two-wheelers
- ✓ **Four Layers:** Third-party liability, occupant liability, personal accident and own-damage cover
- ✓ **Digital Integration:** Bima Sugam
- ✓ **ESOP Requirement:** Prior IRDAI approval for shareholding beyond prescribed limits
- ✓ **Shareholding Thresholds**: 5%, 10%, 25%, 50% and 75%
- ✓ **Share Transfer Approval Fee**: Reduced from Rs 50 lakh to Rs 10 lakh.

New Structure Overview:

Objective: The initiative aims to provide vehicle owners with greater flexibility and transparency by allowing them to choose different insurance covers separately.

Applicable to: The directions apply to all general insurers, except stand-alone health insurers and specialised insurers.

Premium Disclosure: Insurers must separately disclose the actual coverage and premium charged for each section in the policy schedule.

- Insurers must provide a standard Customer Option Form and Customer Information Sheet **(CIS),** detailing the coverage options and premiums for each section of the motor insurance policy.

Integration: IRDAI has directed insurers to integrate the new four-layer structure with **Bima Sugam,** the digital insurance market place.

Four Layers of Motor Insurance:

Section I – Liability to third parties (mandatory): Covers the vehicle owner's legal liability for injury, death, or property damage caused to a third party in an accident.

- This cover is compulsory under motor vehicle law.

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Section II – Legal liability to occupants or pillion riders, including employees of the insured (optional): Covers the vehicle owner's legal liability towards passengers travelling in the insured car or pillion riders (person seated behind the driver) on two-wheelers.

- It can also include employees of the insured.

Section III – Personal accident cover: Includes mandatory personal accident cover for the owner-insured, along with an optional personal accident cover for occupants, pillion riders and drivers other than the owner-driver.

Section IV – Loss of or damage to the vehicle insured (optional): Covers loss of or damage to the insured vehicle.

ESOP Norms and Share Transfer Rules:

Applicable to: The directions apply to all Insurers, except branches of foreign reinsurers, as well as applicants seeking registration to carry on insurance business.

Fee Reduction: The processing fee for applications seeking regulatory approval for the transfer of shares in an insurance company has been reduced from **Rs 50 lakhs** to **Rs 10 lakhs,** an 80% reduction.

- The revised fees apply to share-transfer approval applications under **Regulation 22(4),** effective from 2 November 2026.

Share Transfer Rules: Prior approval is required when shareholdings cross specified thresholds of 5%, 10%, 25%, 50% or 75%, subject to applicable conditions.

IPO Disclosure: Insurance companies planning to list their shares on stock exchanges must provide details of the proposed Initial Public Offering (IPO), including:

- Total size and purpose of the IPO
- Number of fresh shares to be issued
- Number of existing shares offered for sale by current shareholders (Offer for Sale – OFS)
- Existing and expected post-listing shareholding patterns

ESOP: Shares issued under ESOPs, including those issued through a trust set up for employees, will have to comply with the shareholding requirements under the Insurance Act and the registration regulations.

- If the exercise of ESOPs by key managerial personnel or directors crosses the prescribed shareholding limit, the insurer will have to obtain prior approval from IRDAI.

Reporting Rules: Proposed insurer amalgamations and transfers will require an independent actuarial assessment of their impact on solvency, technical reserves, product pricing and financial condition.

- Insurers issuing Other Forms of Capital must also submit detailed allotment information within **15 days.**

About Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI):

IRDAI was constituted in 1999 and was incorporated as a statutory body in April, 2000.

Chairperson – Ajay Seth

Headquarters – Hyderabad, Telangana

SEBI Signs MoU with Digital India BHASHINI Division to Expand Regional-Language Services

On 3 November 2026, the Securities and Exchange Board of India **(SEBI)** signed a Memorandum of Understanding **(MoU)** with the Digital India BHASHINI(Bhasha Interface for India) Division **(DIBD)**,under the Digital India Corporation (DIC) within the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), to improve **access to investor education**, financial information and SEBI services in regional **Indian languages**.

- The MoU was formally signed by Amitabh Nag, Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of DIBD, and Sandip Pradhan, Whole-Time Member of the SEBI.

Exam Hints:

✓ **What?** MoU signed to expand regional-language access

- ✓ **Parties:** SEBI and DIBD
- ✓ **Signatories:** Sandip Pradhan (SEBI); Amitabh Nag(DIBD)
- ✓ **Technology:** ASR, TTS, Machine Translation and OCR.

About SEBI–BHASHINI MoU:

Integration: The MoU enables SEBI to use BHASHINI's language translation Application Programming Interfaces **(APIs)**, models and tools to provide its services in regional Indian languages.

Language Tools: The collaboration includes Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR), Text-to-Speech (TTS), Machine Translation and Optical Character Recognition (OCR) to support speech conversion, translation and text extraction.

Securities Market Terminology: The collaboration will enhance BHASHINI's language models by incorporating securities market-related terms, improving the relevance and accuracy of financial and regulatory translations.

ECONOMY & BUSINESS

IZI Enterprise Secures DRDO Order for Indigenous VANA Multi-Mission UAV Platform

In November 2026, **IZI Enterprise,** deep-tech drone company, secured an order from the Proof & Experimental Establishment **(PXE)** of the Defence Research and Development Organisation **(DRDO)** for the supply and deployment of its indigenous **IZI VANA Surveillance Drone platform.**

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Order for the supply and deployment of the indigenous IZI VANA.
- ✓ **Secured by:** IZI Enterprise, Deep-tech drone company
- ✓ **Order From:** PXE (DRDO).
- ✓ **Applications:** Aerial photogrammetry, precision mapping, surveillance and aerial observation.
- ✓ **Imaging:** Optical, thermal and high-resolution imaging.
- ✓ **Navigation:** GNSS based navigation and autonomous waypoint missions.

Highlights of the IZI VANA Surveillance Drone Platform:

Applications: It Supports aerial photogrammetry, precision mapping, terrain data collection, surveillance, aerial observation, and optical and thermal imaging for DRDO evaluation.

Capabilities: It enables **real-time transmission** of aerial video and mission data, precision navigation, autonomous waypoint-based missions, and flight and sensor-data logging for post-mission analysis, and designed to operate in demanding environmental conditions.

Configuration: The platform features high-resolution imaging, Red-Green-Blue **(RGB)** and Electro-Optical/Infrared (EO/IR) sensors, Global Navigation Satellite System **(GNSS)** and a Ground Control Station (GCS) for automated mission planning, geofencing and autonomous waypoint navigation.

Deployment: IZI will provide **two** Directorate General of Civil Aviation **(DGCA)**-certified pilots for the first year to support flight operations and train personnel, with VANA classified as an Aerial Photogrammetry Platform (Drones) of Indian origin.

About IZI Enterprise: Founded in 2013, IZI is headquartered in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh (MP), and is founded by Ishan Haydn.

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APPOINTMENTS & RESIGNATIONS

Equitas Small Finance Bank Appoints Balaji Nuthalapadi as Interim CEO

In November 2026, Equitas Small Finance Bank **(SFB)** appointed its whole-Time Director and Executive Director **(ED)**, **Balaji Nuthalapadi,** as **Interim** Chief Executive Officer **(CEO)**, following the recommendation of its Nomination and Remuneration Committee and approval by the Board, subject to Reserve Bank of India **(RBI)** approval.

- The appointment followed the resignation of MD and CEO **P. N. Vasudevan** on 29 October 2026.

Exam hints:

- ✓ **What?** Appointment of Interim CEO of Equitas SFB
- ✓ **Who?** Balaji Nuthalapadi.
- ✓ **When?** 3 November 2026.
- ✓ **Recommended By:** Nomination and Remuneration Committee
- ✓ **Approval:** Subject to RBI Approval
- ✓ **Predecessor:**P. N. Vasudevan

About Balaji Nuthalapadi:

Career: He began his banking career with **Citibank** in Chennai, Tamil Nadu (TN) in 1997 and gained over **28 years** of experience across banking operations, technology and financial services.
Leadership: Served as MD and Head of **India Citi Solutions Centers**, as well as Head of India Operations and Technology. He also played a key role in expanding and scaling Citi's global capability hubs in India.
Equitas: Joined Equitas SFB and has been serving as ED – Technology and Operations since March 2025, overseeing key technology and operational functions.
Previous Assignment: In September 2024, he served as MDand Head of Centralized Controls Testing Execution at Citi. He also took over as Head of South Asia Operations and Technology (O&T) in May 2021.
Expertise: His professional experience spans operations and technology management, global capability centre leadership, wealth management, asset sales, consumer banking, process re-engineering and business operations.

About Equitas Small Finance Bank (SFB):

Overview: Equitas SFB is an Indian small finance bank headquartered in Chennai, Tamil Nadu, established in 2016 to promote financial inclusion by providing banking and credit services to individuals, micro-enterprises, small businesses and other underserved customer segments.
Corporate Restructuring: Equitas Holdings Limited was amalgamated with Equitas SFB in March 2023, following which it ceased to exist as a separate holding company.

ACQUISITIONS & MERGERS

CCI Approves KMBL's Acquisition of Deutsche Bank's Retail and Wealth Management Businesses

On 3 November 2026, the Competition Commission of India **(CCI)** approved Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited **(KMBL)'s** proposed acquisition of the retail banking, private banking and wealth management businesses of Germany-based Deutsche Bank Aktiengesellschaft **(Deutsche Bank AG) in India.**

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** CCI approves acquisition
- ✓ **Acquirer:** Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited
- ✓ **Seller**: Deutsche Bank AG, Germany
- ✓ **Businesses**: Retail banking, private banking and wealth management

- ✓ **Transaction Type:** Slump sale on a going-concern basis.

Key Details of Acquisition:

Transaction Structure: The acquisition will be undertaken as a going concern on a **slump sale basis,** involving the transfer of the identified business undertaking rather than the purchase of individual assets separately.

Business Coverage: The acquired operations include deposits, loans, investments, insurance and foreign exchange services, while the wealth management segment caters primarily to High-Net-Worth Individuals (HNIs).

Referral Arrangements: The banks, through their affiliates, also plan to establish referral arrangements for customers of the investment advisory and portfolio management services businesses of Deutsche Investments India Private Limited **(DIIPL)**, an indirect wholly owned subsidiary of Deutsche Bank.

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

DRDO Successfully Tests Pralay Quasi-Ballistic Missile off Odisha Coast

On 3 November 2026, the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) successfully test-fired the **Pralay surface-to-surface quasi-ballistic missile** at the Integrated Test Range **(ITR)**, Chandipur, Odisha.

- The missile was launched from Launch **Complex-3** and successfully engaged two simulated targets located approximately **500** kilometres **(km)** away.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Successful test-firing of the Pralay surface-to-surface quasi-ballistic missile
- ✓ **By Whom?** DRDO
- ✓ **When?** 3 November 2026.
- ✓ **Where?** Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur, Odisha.
- ✓ **Target Range:** 500 km.
- ✓ **Speed:** Reportedly achieved Mach 5.
- ✓ **Operational Range:** 150–500 km.
- ✓ **Payload Capacity:** 350–1,000 kg.
- ✓ **Production Partners:** BDL and BEL.

Background:

Initial Tests: DRDO conducted the first test of the Pralay missile in December 2021, followed by two successful consecutive tests off the Odisha coast in July 2025.

User Evaluation Trials: In December 2025, DRDO successfully launched two Pralay missiles in quick succession from the same launcher as part of user evaluation trials. Both missiles followed their intended trajectories and met all flight-test objectives.

Highlights of the Pralay Missile:

Manoeuvrability: The missile achieves speed of **Mach 5** (approximately **6,174 km/hour,** Km/h) and follows a quasi-ballistic trajectory with in-flight manoeuvrability, including during the terminal phase, making interception by enemy air defence systems challenging.

Warhead: It can carry **multiple types of warheads** to strike various targets with high precision and uses a solid-propellant rocket motor for prolonged ready-to-launch storage and rapid deployment.

Range & Mobility: The missile has an operational range of **150–500 km** and can carry payloads weighing 350–1,000 Kilograms (kg), allowing it to accommodate different warhead configurations depending on the selected range and can be launched from road-mobile platforms, offering operational flexibility.

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Development: It was developed by DRDO's Research Centre Imarat (RCI), Hyderabad, in collaboration with other DRDO laboratories with Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL) and Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) as development-cum-production partners.
Induction: Over 2,500 residents within a 2-km radius were temporarily relocated, while a Notice to Airmen (NOTAM) covering approximately 595 km was issued ahead of the test.

- The missile is mounted on a **12×12 high-mobility vehicle** and intended for induction into the Indian Army (IA) and Indian Air Force (IAF).

About Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO):
The **DRDO** is an agency under the Department of Defence Research and Development in the Ministry of Defence (MoD) of the Government of India (GoI), charged with the military's research and development (R&D).
Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh
Headquarters – DRDO Bhawan, New Delhi, Delhi.
Establishment – 1958

Pakistan Successfully Tests Indigenous Fa'az Air-to-Air Missile

On 3 November 2026, **Pakistan** successfully **conducted** the first flight test of its indigenously developed **Fa'az air-to-air missile,** from a JF-17 Thunder multirole fighter aircraft, to strengthen Pakistan's domestic missile development, defence manufacturing and self-reliance in air-to-air weapon systems.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Successful flight test of the indigenous Fa'az air-to-air missile
- ✓ **Country:** Pakistan
- ✓ **Developed By:** Pakistan's indigenous defence development programme
- ✓ **Significance:** Pakistan's first locally developed air-to-air missile
- ✓ **Guidance System:** Advanced terminal guidance system

About Fa'az Missile Test:
Guidance: The missile features an advanced terminal guidance system designed to track, home in on and engage fast-moving hostile aircraft during the final phase of flight.
Capabilities: According to the Inter-Services Public Relations (ISPR), its extended-range engagement capability is expected to enhance the operational flexibility and defensive and offensive capabilities of the Pakistan Air Force (PAF).
Significance: The indigenous weapon system aims to reduce dependence on imported air-to-air missiles and strengthen Pakistan's defence self-reliance, particularly during crises.
About Pakistan: Capital – Capital – Islamabad; President – Asif Ali Zardari; Prime Minister (PM) – Mian Muhammad Shehbaz Sharif; Currency – Pakistani Rupee (PKR).

SPORTS

Tammer Boxing Tournament 2026: India Tops with 14 Medals Including 4 Gold

In November 2026, **Indian boxers** topped the overall medal standings at the **46th International Tammer Boxing Tournament**, organised by the **Tampere Boxing Association,** in Tampere, Finland, from 30 October to 1 November, winning **14 medals (4 gold, 2 silver and 8 bronze).**

- The 14-member Indian squad, ranked third in Olympic weight-category bench strength, competed in 10 men's and 7 women's categories under World Boxing rules.

Exam hints:

- ✓ **What?** 46th International Tammer Boxing Tournament.

- ✓ **When?** 30 October to 1 November 2026.
- ✓ **Where?** Tampere, Finland.
- ✓ **Organiser:** Tampere Boxing Association.
- ✓ **Winner:** India topped the medal tally
- ✓ **Total Medals:**14 (4 Gold, 2 Silver and 8 Bronze).
- ✓ **Gold Winners:** Aarti Dhariyal, Ankushita Boro, Arundhati Chaudhary and Pawan Bartwal.

Highlights of the 46th International Tammer Boxing Tournament:

Gold: Aarti Dhariyal won gold in the 54 kg category by defeating Scotland's Stephanie Kernachan (5–0), **Ankushita Boro** won gold in the 65 kg category by defeating England's Ella Thompstone (4–1).

- Indian Army (IA) boxers **Havildar Arundhati Chaudhary**, a Commonwealth Games gold medallist, won gold in the women's 70 kg category by defeating Ireland's Evelyn Ivie Igharo (3–2), while **Havildar Pawan Bartwal** secured gold in the men's 55 kg category.

Silver: IA boxers Subedar Mohammed Hussamuddin (men's 60 kg) and Naib Subedar Jaismine Lamboria (women's 57 kg) secured silver medals.

Bronze: Vivek Meena (men's 65 kg), Hitesh (men's 70 kg), Akshay (men's 80 kg), Bobin Chauhan (men's 90 kg), Chetan Choudhary (men's 90+ kg), Disha Patil (women's 60 kg) and Imroz Khan (women's 75 kg), IA boxer Havildar Tanu (women's 51 kg) won bronze medals.

About International Tammer Boxing Tournament: Established in 1977, the annual tournament is held in Tampere, Finland, under the presidency of Henry Forss.

IMPORTANT DAYS

World Tsunami Awareness Day 2026 – November 5

The United Nations (UN), through the UN Office for Disaster Risk Reduction **(UNDRR)**, observes World Tsunami Awareness Day **(WTAD)** annually on **5 November** to promote tsunami preparedness, strengthen community resilience and reduce tsunami-related risks.

- 5 November 2026 marks the **11th** observance of WTAD

Theme:

2026 Theme: "Be Tsunami Ready: Resilience Starts With You".

Focus: Strengthening individual and community tsunami preparedness through early warning awareness, timely evacuation, emergency planning, community drills and inclusive support for vulnerable groups.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** World Tsunami Awareness Day 2026(11th)
- ✓ **When?** November 5, 2026
- ✓ **2026 Theme:** "Be Tsunami Ready: Resilience Starts With You"
- ✓ **Lead Agency:** UNDRR with UN partners
- ✓ **First Observed:** 5 November 2016
- ✓ **Linked Framework:** Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction (2015–2030)
- ✓ **2026 Event:** Bangkok, Thailand.

Background:

Adoption: On 22 December **2015,** the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) adopted Resolution A/RES/70/203, designating 5 November as WTAD, following an initiative led by Japan.

First Observance: The first WTAD was observed on **5 November 2016.**

Significance of 5 November: Commemorates Japan's **Inamura-no-hi** (Burning of the Rice Sheaves) story 1854, when farmer Goryo Hamaguchi warned villagers of an approaching tsunami by setting fire to rice sheaves.

Global Frameworks:

Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction (2015–2030): Focuses on reducing disaster risks and preventing losses of lives, livelihoods and economic assets by **2030**.

- The SFDRR 2015–2030, a 15-year global framework, was adopted at the 3rd UN World Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction in March 2015 in Sendai, Japan, succeeding the Hyogo Framework for Action.

Early Warnings for All (EW4All) Initiative: Launched by the UN in 2022, the initiative aims to ensure universal protection through multi-hazard early warning systems by 2027, focusing on disaster risk assessment, hazard monitoring, timely warnings and preparedness for effective tsunami evacuation.

#GetToHighGround Campaign (2022): Launched by the UNDRR, the campaign promotes tsunami preparedness through evacuation drills, guided walks, awareness of natural warning signs and identification of safe evacuation routes.

2026 Event:

Event: On 27 October 2026, an interactive session was organised at the United Nations Conference Centre (UNCC) in **Bangkok, Thailand**, to promote tsunami awareness and preparedness through educational activities.

Organisers: The session was jointly organised by the United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction–Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific (UNDRR-ROAP), United Nations Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific (UN-ESCAP), United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and UNESCO's Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (UNESCO-IOC).

India's Tsunami Preparedness 2026:

Tsunami Monitoring: The Indian Tsunami Early Warning Centre **(ITEWC)**, operated by the Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services **(INCOIS)**, Hyderabad (Telangana), provides **24×7** tsunami monitoring and can detect potential tsunami-generating earthquakes **within 10 minutes**.

Tsunami Ready Villages: In 2020, Noliasahi (Jagatsinghpur) and Venkatraipur (Ganjam) in Odisha became the first two UNESCO-IOC Tsunami Ready villages in the Indian Ocean Region (IOR).

- In October 2026, Odisha added 74 coastal villages, taking its total to 100 recognised villages.

About United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction (UNDRR):

Head – Kamal Kishore
Headquarters – Geneva, Switzerland
Established – 1999



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Less Important NEWS

- Rajiv Ranjan Singh to Inaugurate National Workshop on People's Plan Campaign 2026-27 in New Delhi on October 30
- Trio of Indian Navy's first training squadron ships concludes visit to Sri Lanka
- Patrick Stewart, Shakespearean actor turned 'Star Trek' and 'X-Men' star, dies at 86
- S Sadanandam, Renowned Ilaiyaraaja Guitarist, Dies at 79 in Chennai
- Vice-President calls for holistic rural development to realise Viksit Bharat 2047; graces Golden Jubilee Celebrations and 39th Convocation of Gandhigram Rural Institute

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